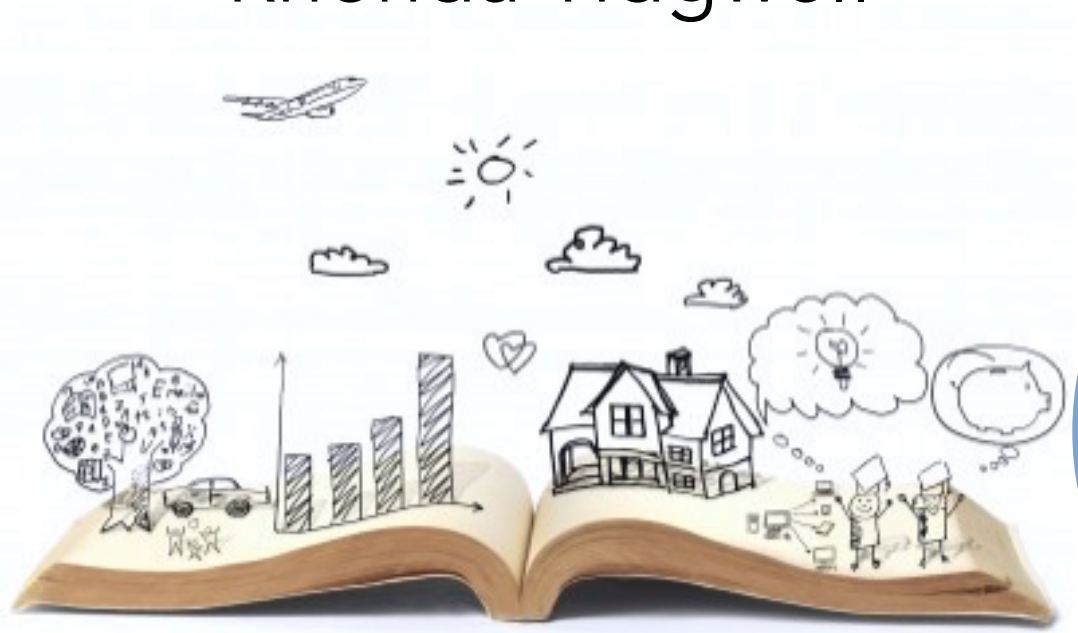
Library Learning Commons
Vision for Learning & Long-Range Action Plan

Rhonda Tidgwell



LIBRARY LEARNING COMMONS VISION FOR LEARNING:

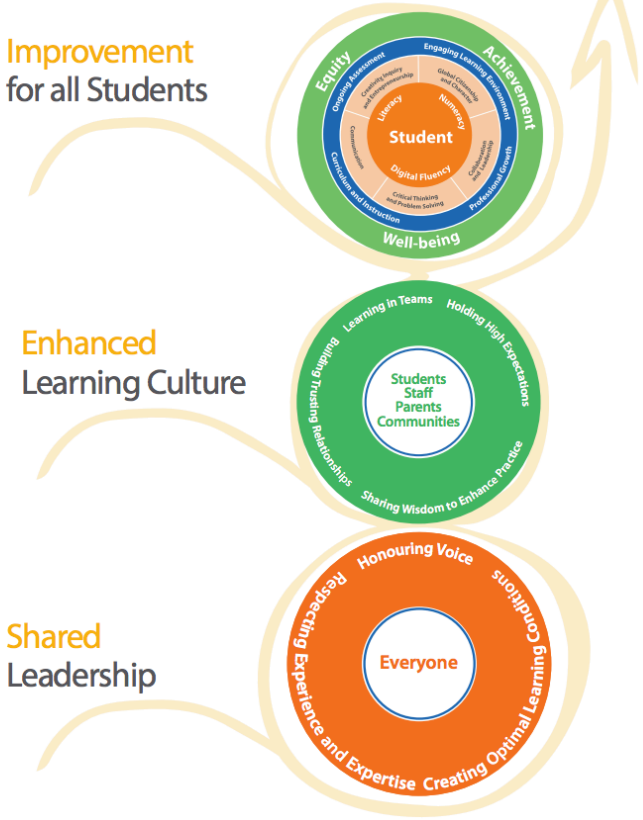
In the role of Teacher-Librarian, I aim to inspire, challenge, and support each learner in achieving excellence in academic growth, global citizenship, and personal well-being. In the Library Learning Commons, I will model innovation and critical thinking through the delivery of inquiry-based instruction, supported by technology.

PRIORITIES / RATIONALE / ALIGNMENT WITH VPMS SCHOOL GOALS:

Valley Park Middle School is a large community school with a tradition of excellence where, in partnership with parents, we value and celebrate our multicultural diversity. At Valley Park, we believe that learning is a lifelong commitment. We believe that the academic, social, emotional, physical and attitudinal needs of our students are our prime concerns and that our programs address these needs.

Valley Park is a large inner city school serving the communities of Thorncliffe and Flemingdon. The school serves the needs of about 1,200 students representing over 50 language groups. Valley Park's Code of Behaviour clearly communicates to students, parents and staff the expectations related to our motto, "Respect for All".

TDSB Vision for Learning

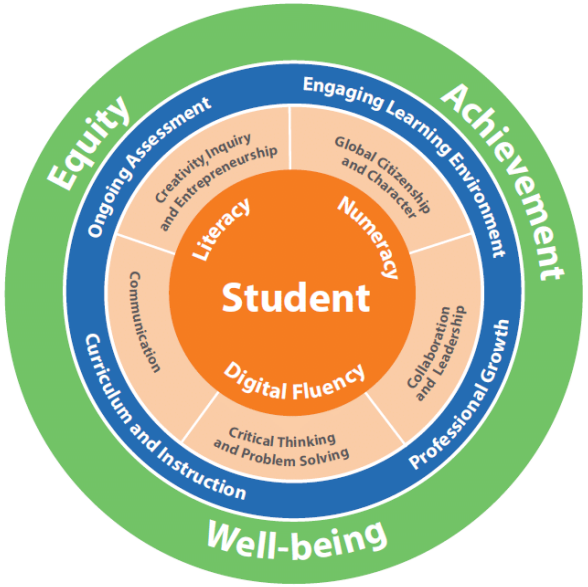


We have a foundational commitment to equity, student achievement, and well-being, supported by technology through the lens of global competencies.

Action:

Every school, in partnership with their superintendent and school community, will develop authentic foci where equity is embedded throughout the school community.

It is through equity, that we will enable student achievement, well-being and learning.



LIBRARY LEARNING COMMONS LONG-RANGE ACTION PLAN

DESIGN PRIORITIES /IDEAS TO MAINTAIN OR CHANGE	RATIONALE / CONSIDERATIONS
-Extend library hours, update bulletin boards monthly/include student voice -Keep open computer lab area, tables, and shelving -Keep round table area with smartboard, but add new white-board tables for collaboration -Add "trending" books displays in library windows, and on visible table / in view -Empty tech. storage room (store technology in TL office cupboards) -Use that office as new Maker-space (use existing shelves, but add a green-screen) -begin Instagram posts/blog, plus digital magazine for news, events, and updates	-Continue the transition from a traditional library to a 21st century learning space -Create a community of collaboration through a more inviting and functional space -Include more opportunities for teaching and learning using technology and virtual spaces -Promote through the website, digital newsletter, and social media
RESOURCES THAT SUPPORT AN INCLUSIVE LIBRARY SPACE	**RATIONALE / CONSIDERATIONS**
-Conduct a stakeholder survey for staff/student/parent input -Weed book collection for outdated resources and books not being circulated -Feature/recommend books that are hidden, but might be of interest -Confirm student enrollment and budget allocation -Edit/draft budget (align with School Improvement Plan) -Submit proposed budget to administration (leave room for new purchases) -Add books featuring Muslim youth to the collection (Another Story Book Shop, Girls of the Crescent, Tinlids) -Attend book warehouse sales -Attend parent council meeting early in year, and again for Forest of Reading pitch + invite parents to volunteer/get involved	-Maintain a current and up-to-date collection which is also reflective of the school community and provides a variety of perspectives -Advocate through the creation of a balanced budget reflecting the needs of the school community and the school's goals
SERVICES AND PROGRAMS	**RATIONALE / CONSIDERATIONS**
-Post/blog on Instagram, plus create digital magazine for news, events, and updates -Update bulletin boards monthly -Post digital updates on cafeteria/atrium TVs -Present updates at staff meetings and parent council meetings -Participate in partnering, co-planning and teaching -Offer lunch-n-learns to promote technology, resources -Start Maker Club -Run Scholastic Book Fair -Host stations at Family Literacy Night & Family Math Night -Enroll school in Forest of Reading Program -Assemble a Learning Commons Crew (student helpers) and volunteers (parent helpers) -Connect with public libraries and TLs outside of the school	-Communicate regularly with staff, students, and parents to co-create a community of collaboration and foster an inclusive environment -Support creativity, critical thinking and innovation through inquiry, technology, digital learning, and STEM-based activities -Invite and encourage student voice -Create a group of advocates through fostering positive relationships within the school community and beyond

LIBRARY LEARNING COMMONS PROPOSED BUDGET AT-A-GLANCE ($6000—$8000)

ITEMS	ESTIMATED COST
Inclusive and Diverse Books and Resources	$3000
Podcasting Centre and Maker-space	$1000
Flexible Seating (includes whiteboard tables)	$2000
Forest of Learning Reading Program	*Funding provided by Parent Council
Total	$6000

ENCOURAGING A COMMUNITY OF RECREATIONAL READING LONG-RANGE PLAN

	Month	Themes for displays. Mini-lessons & Read Alouds	Learning Commons Events	STEM / Maker Pop-ups	Weekly use of space during lunch hours	Ongoing	Once in a While
	September	Introduction to the LC, Virtual Library, and kid-friendly tools Totally Middle School Read-alouds Getting to School picture book read-aloud LC Scavenger Hunt	Kahoots (fun digital quiz game introducing students to the LC, the collection, and literature)	Bookmark design contest (winners to be printed in colour for whole school)	Robotics Club begins Learning Commons Crew meets Tuesdays & Thursdays MAKER Mondays TECH Tuesdays WELLNESS Wednesdays WONDER Wednesdays (wonderopolis) THINKER Thursdays (peer tutoring)	Distribute technology, set up sign-outs for carts Create class visits schedule Create Stakeholder survey DAILY— -Post on social media (Instagram) WEEKLY— Update webpage BI-WEEKLY— Class library visits on rotation MONTHLY— -Update digital magazine (#trending) MONTHLY— -Update displays and bulletin boards Partnering (ongoing) Involvement in SIP with admin.	Manage LC budget Request funds from Parent Council Check in with staff re. technology "Tastings"— Lunch n' Learns for Staff on books, resources, and technology: Let's TACO 'bout Books (taco lunch) FRY-YAY! (french-fry theme) Sweet Reads (dessert theme) Appetizing Apps (appetizer theme) Host PLCs
FALL	October	Indigenous Education Month – Orange Shirt Day International Day if the Girl + Body Confidence Awareness	SOCK-tober (home-insecurity awareness + sock drive) Family Math Night Station	Slime-making Whole school zombie attack STEM challenge			
FALL	November	Remembrance Day International Day for the Elimination of Violence Against Women	SOCK Drive continues Scholastic Book Fair (overlap with parent conferences)	Marble mazes Robotics begins			
FALL	December	Festival of Lights (Diwali, Hanukkah, Winter Solstice, Christmas…)	Festival of Lights	Penny spinners			
WINTER	January	Growth Mindsets Forest of Reading presentations Author Spotlight Holocaust Remembrance	Arrange author visits (includes digital) Grade 6 trip to public library	Lego night lights			
WINTER	February	African Heritage Month Family Day (family diversity)	Family Day / Reading as a Family (literacy stations)	Using the green-screen + prop-making			
WINTER	March	Sikh New Year / Cultural diversity	Family Culture Night	VR Viewers & VR apps			

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SPRING	April	International Day of Pink Earth Day Mystery Skype	Earth Day / Earth Hour Unplugged Grade 7 trip to public library	Voice-recordings & videos	FOREST Fridays (Virtual Author Visits – Forest of Reading) Spring— Campfire Book Talks (Forest of Reading) Robotics ends (mid-May) Collection of books and resources, re-shelving	DAILY— -Post on social media (Instagram) WEEKLY— Update webpage BI-WEEKLY— Class library visits on rotation MONTHLY— -Update digital magazine (#trending) MONTHLY— -Update displays and bulletin boards Partnering (ongoing) Involvement in SIP with admin.	Check in with staff re. technology Manage LC budget "Tastings"— Lunch n' Learns for Staff on books, resources, and technology: Let's TACO 'bout Books (taco lunch) FRY-YAY! (french-fry theme) Sweet Reads (dessert theme) Appetizing Apps (appetizer theme) Host PLCs
	May	Challenging Gender Stereotypes International Day Against Homophobia & Transphobia Asian Heritage	Eid Celebration (samosas and sweets readings) Woodland Celebration (Forest of Reading)	How strong is spaghetti? STEM Challenge			
	June	Toronto Pride National Aboriginal Day Summer Solstice	Pride Author Visits Grade 8 trip to public library	Take inventory of technology in the school			

Learning Commons Budget & Wish List for a Diverse & Inclusive Collection

Item	Topic(s)	Format / Category	ISBN or Item Code	Vendor	Price	Rationale
FIRST NATIONS, METIS, INUIT / LGBTQ2 / MENTAL HEALTH AWARENESS / CHARACTER EDUCTATION						
The Marrow Thieves Cherie Dimaline	FNMI Contemporary Fict Residential School	paperback	9781770864863	GoodMinds.com	$14.95	- Preservation of Indigenous culture and traditions - Recognition of Indigenous history - Truth and Reconciliation of Indigenous experience, including the residential school experience - Importance of developing character education traits in students to enhance well-being - Recognition of mental health as part of overall health, and elimination of stigma around mental health issues - Importance of eradicating homophobia and homophobic stereotypes - Importance of including, and representing, all students and their families
The Secret Path Gord Downie	FNMI Residential School Experience Social Studies	paperback	9781501155949	Amazon.ca GoodMinds.com	$18.89	
You Hold Me Up Monique Gray Smith	Character Ed Empathy	hardcover picture book	9781459814479	Tinlids.ca	$15.96	
I am Peace Susan Verde	Mental Health Mindfulness	Hardcover picture book	141972701X	Amazon.ca	$16.79	
Saving Montgomery Sole Mariko Tamaki	LGBTQ homophobia	paperback	9780143180968	Tinlids.ca	$10.40	
The Other Boy M.G. Hennessey	LGBTQ Transgender Social themes	hardcover	9780062427663	Amazon.ca	$18.86	
GRAPHIC NOVELS (including French)						
Maus 1 & Maus 2 Set Art Spiegelman	History / WWII Holocaust	paperback	9780394747231	Amazon.ca Tinlids.ca	$30.70	I chose a variety of engaging texts which cover history, to a pre-teen coming of age series, which is also available in French.
Soeurs (French) Raina Telgemeier	Coming of age Collaboration	paperback	1443138231	Amazon.ca	$14.03	
A Girl Called Echo: Pemmican Wars Katherena Vermette	Contemporary FNMI Fiction Preservation of culture	paperback	9781553796787	Tinlids.ca	$17.06	

Item	Description	Format / Category	ISBN or Item Code	Vendor	Price	Rationale
BOOKS REPRESENTING DIVERSITY						
Amal Unbound Aisha Saeed	Pakistani/ Muslim culture Social justice	paperback fiction	9780399544682	Tinlids.ca	18.40	I chose to focus on Muslim culture so that kids at my school can find themselves in the literature. We focus so much on other cultures, which is by all means necessary and will continue, but I do believe that my school library needs more books featuring characters, and written by authors, that reflect our school community.
Love, hate & Other Filters Samira Ahmend	Muslim culture Islamophobia	Hardcover fiction	1616958472	Amazon.ca	$19.79	
Lailah's Lunchbox Reem Faruqi	Muslim culture Ramadan	hardcover picture book	978-0-88448-4318	Amazon.ca	$20.22	
She Wore Red Trainers: A Muslim Love Story Na'ima B. Robert	Muslim culture Growth & Development	paperback fiction	1847740650	Amazon.ca	$16.36	
Does My Head Look Big in This? Randa Abdel- Fattah	Muslim culture Racism	paperback fiction	043992233X	Amazon.ca	$10.88	
I am Malala Malala Yousafzai	Biography Social Justice Women's Rights Muslim Culture	paperback	9780316327916	Tinlids.ca	$11.60	
E-BOOKS & AUDIO-BOOKS TO SUPPORT ENIGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNERS (especially Urdu)						
Am I small? لیکن میں چھوٹی ہوں؟: Philipp Winterberg	Children's Picture Book English-Urdu	audiobook	ASIN: B00LAGEMJ8	Amazon Digital Services	$13.07	The majority of ELLs at my school speak Urdu, so I chose an Urdu-English dual language book. I also added a book related to the Social Studies curriculum in order to give ELLs better access to information.
What Was the Underground Railroad?	Black History Social Studies Immigration Racism	audiobook	ASIN: B00EV4Z2QS	Amazon.ca Digital	$7.99	

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PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT / TEACHER RESOURCES						
One Without the Other: Stories of Unity Through Diversity and Inclusion by Shelley Moore	Collaborative Inquiry Diversity Inclusion	softcover	SKU: 978-1-55379-658-9	Portage & Main Press	$17.00	Current and meaningful topics for educators: -Diversity -Inclusion -Inquiry -STEM -Maker-spaces -Digital citizenship
Maker Lab: 28 Super Cool Projects Jack Challoner	Maker Spaces Digital Citizenship	hardcover	1465451358	Amazon.ca	$13.99	
UPDATED NON-FICTION BOOKS TO SUPPORT THE SOCIAL STUDIES CURRICULUM						
We Are All Born Free: The Universal Declaration of Human Rights in Pictures by Amnesty International	hardcover non-fiction Social Studies Social Justice Global Connections	paperback	1847806635	Amazon.ca	$9.99	I chose books that can tie into any grade's Social Studies curriculum: -Human Rights -Rights of the Child -Change-making -Advocacy -Social Justice -Inquiry -Action -Global Connections -Canada's connections to the world -World organizations -Global citizenship
Hands On Social Studies: An Inquiry Approach Jennifer Laws	teacher resource Inquiry Social Studies Global connections	softcover	SKU: 978-1-55379-516-2	Portage & Main Press	$135.00	
Malala, a Brave Girl from Pakistan/Iqbal, a Brave Boy from Pakistan: Two Stories of Bravery Jeanette Winter	Non-fiction hardcover Social justice Activism Global Connections	hardcover	1481422944	Amazon.ca	$12.26	

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PODCAST RECORDING ZONE						
Garageband (on Apple iPad for schools)	Recording software	Digital Literacy		Apple	$299 x 2	-Digital literacy -Digital fluency -21st century learning
Blue Microphones Yeti USB *with headphones	Recording equipment		B00N1YPXW2	Amazon.ca	$136.55 each x 2	
STEM / MAKERSPACE START-UP						
Lego Wall	Lego Baseplates 10x10 cm	STEM / Makerspace	B00NHQF65S	Amazon.ca	$5.69 each x 25	-STEM -Makerspace -Collaboration -Inquiry -Creativity
DIY Green Screen	fabric			Fabric store	$40	
Kleanner Tripod	Tablet Floor-stand/tripod		B075R7PQGW	Amazon.ca	$32.99	
FLEXIBLE SEATING & COLLABORATIVE FURNITURE						
ECR4Kids Dry Erase 30" Round Table	w/Glides + Casters Adjustable Height 19-30 inch	Flexible / mobile seating	0763960679395	Amazon.ca	$129.99 each x 6	Items chosen with this in mind: -Flexible seating -Mobile Furniture -Collaboration encouragement
CanDo Inflatable Donut Balls	33.5" diam inflatable donuts		714905053510	Amazon.ca	$22.25 each x 6	
Beanbag chairs	121" chairs		SKU # 28748006	Brodart.ca	$118 each x 6	
DATABASE SUBSCRIPTIONS						
Curio	CBC Canada	digital		Curio.ca	free	Current audio-visual content in English and French
Learn 360	Video subscription	digital		Learn 360	*must contact	

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